

# We Establish the Torah

## *What Paul Really Taught About Grace, Faith, and the Instructions of YHWH*

A Deep Dive Through Paul's Letters and the Scriptures He Was Quoting

Scripture quoted from the World English Bible, divine name rendered YHWH, Elohim, and Adonai, with Yahshua and Messiah restored. Quoted verses keep the WEB word law; in the teaching itself Torah is called the instructions of YHWH. Strong's numbers are given for word studies.

### THE HEART OF IT

Many believers have been taught that Paul ended the instructions of YHWH, that they were for the Jews, and that grace means we are no longer expected to keep them. Yet in the very same breath where Paul says we are justified by faith, he asks if faith cancels the Torah and answers, **May it never be! No, we establish the law (Romans 3:31).**

Paul teaches three truths that stand together, and every one of them comes straight out of Moses and the Prophets: **no one is made righteous by keeping the instructions, the instructions are not abolished, and we are saved by grace through faith, and the faith that saves goes to work.** Pull any one of the three out and Paul stops making sense. Keep all three and his letters open up.

### SECTION I

## Read Paul the Way He Asked to Be Read

Before we open a single letter, Scripture itself gives us a warning label. Peter, writing near the end of his life, calls Paul a beloved brother and then says something that should make every Bible reader slow down:

*Regard the patience of our Adonai as salvation; even as our beloved brother Paul also, according to the wisdom given to him, wrote to you, as also in all of his letters, speaking in them of these things. In those, there are some things that are hard to understand, which the ignorant and unsettled twist, as they also do to the other Scriptures, to their own destruction. You therefore, beloved, knowing these things beforehand, beware, lest being carried away with the error of the wicked, you fall from your own steadfastness.*

**2 PETER 3:15-17**

The phrase **the error of the wicked** is one Greek word, *athesmos* (G113). It means lawless, one who sets aside what has been established. Peter is telling us exactly which direction the twisting goes. People would take Paul's hard sayings and use them to walk away from the instructions of Elohim. That is not a modern problem. It was already happening while the apostles were alive, and Peter calls it destruction.

Paul's Bible was what we call the Old Testament. When he told Timothy that every Scripture is Elohim breathed and profitable for teaching, reproof, correction, and instruction in righteousness, the Scriptures Timothy had known

**from infancy** were Moses, the Prophets, and the Writings (**2 Timothy 3:15-17**). The Bereans were called noble because they checked Paul against those Scriptures every day (**Acts 17:11**). So we will do what they did. Every time Paul quotes or echoes the Tanakh, we will go back and read the verse he was standing on.

*But this I confess to you, that after the Way, which they call a sect, so I serve the Elohim of our fathers, believing all things which are according to the law, and which are written in the prophets;*

**ACTS 24:14**

## The Word Behind the Word: Torah

When our English Bibles say *law* in Paul, the Greek word is *nomos* (G3551). The Greek translation of the Old Testament that Paul often quoted used *nomos* for the Hebrew *Torah* (H8451). Torah comes from the root *yarah* (H3384), which means to throw or shoot, as an arrow, and from there to point out and to teach. Torah is instruction. It is YHWH pointing out the target.

Now look at the Hebrew word for sin, *chata* (H2398). Its root meaning is to miss. In Judges 20:16 there were seven hundred left handed men who could sling a stone at a hair **and not miss**, and that word is *chata*. Torah is the aim. Sin is missing it. That is why John can say plainly that sin is lawlessness, *anomia* (G458) (**1 John 3:4**), and why Paul says all have sinned and fall short (**Romans 3:23**).

### ONE WORD, SEVERAL MEANINGS

Paul uses *nomos* in more than one way, and reading every one of them as *the Torah is finished* breaks his letters. He speaks of the Torah itself, quoting **You shall not covet (Romans 7:7)**. He speaks of **a law of faith (Romans 3:27)**, **the law of sin** at war in his body (**Romans 7:23**), and **the law of the Spirit of life (Romans 8:2)**. He also uses phrases like **works of the law** and **under law**, which we will define from Scripture itself. Always ask: which law is Paul talking about, and what is he saying it can or cannot do?

## SECTION II

## Truth One: No One Is Made Righteous by Keeping the Instructions

The Greek word for justify is *dikaioo* (G1344), and it matches the Hebrew *tsadaq* (H6663). It is a courtroom word. It does not mean to make someone a better person over time. It means to declare them righteous, to rule in their favor. Moses told judges to **justify the righteous and condemn the wicked (Deuteronomy 25:1)**. And Isaiah promised that YHWH's righteous servant would **justify many** and bear their iniquities (**Isaiah 53:11**). Paul's whole question is this: on what grounds does the Judge of all the earth rule in a sinner's favor?

*Because by the works of the law, no flesh will be justified in his sight; for through the law comes the knowledge of sin.*

**ROMANS 3:20**

Paul did not invent that line. He is quoting David:

*Don't enter into judgment with your servant, for in your sight no man living is righteous.*

**PSALM 143:2**

The problem is never that the Torah is bad. The problem is that every one of us has already missed the mark. A mirror shows you the dirt on your face, but you do not wash your face with the mirror. The Torah shows us sin. Only YHWH can take it away.

## The Mercy Seat Is in Romans

*being justified freely by his grace through the redemption that is in Messiah Yahshua; whom Elohim sent to be an atoning sacrifice, through faith in his blood, for a demonstration of his righteousness through the passing over of prior sins, in Elohim's forbearance; to demonstrate his righteousness at this present time; that he might himself be just, and the justifier of him who has faith in Yahshua.*

**ROMANS 3:24-26**

Paul says the righteousness of Elohim is revealed apart from the Torah, **being testified by the law and the prophets (Romans 3:21)**. The Torah itself points to the answer. The words **atoning sacrifice** in Romans 3:25 translate *hilasterion* (G2435). That is the very word the Greek Old Testament used for the *kapporet* (H3727), the mercy seat on the ark of the covenant, and Hebrews 9:5 uses the same word for the mercy seat. The mercy seat was where the blood was sprinkled on the Day of Atonement (**Leviticus 16:14-15**), and it was the place where YHWH said, **There I will meet with you (Exodus 25:22)**. Paul is telling us that Yahshua is the mercy seat. The place where Elohim meets sinners is his blood.

And the word **freely** in Romans 3:24 is *dorean* (G1432), as a gift, without cost. The word **redemption** is *apolutrosis* (G629), a full ransom. In Hebrew thought that is the work of the *go'el* (H1350), the kinsman redeemer who buys back what his brother lost (**Leviticus 25:25**). Isaiah names YHWH himself as Israel's Redeemer (**Isaiah 44:6**). Our Redeemer paid what we could never pay.

## Abraham Was Counted Righteous Before Sinai

*We maintain therefore that a man is justified by faith apart from the works of the law.*

**ROMANS 3:28**

*He believed in YHWH, who credited it to him for righteousness.*

**GENESIS 15:6**

Paul's word for **accounted** or **credited** is *logizomai* (G3049). It is a bookkeeping word, and it carries the Hebrew *chashab* (H2803) from Genesis 15:6: to reckon, to count, to credit to someone's account. Abraham believed, and YHWH wrote righteousness into his account. Paul points out when this happened. Genesis 15 comes before circumcision in Genesis 17 (**Romans 4:9-11**), and the covenant with Abraham came four hundred thirty years before Sinai (**Galatians 3:17**). Then Paul brings in David, who blesses the man whose sins are covered and whom YHWH will not charge with sin (**Romans 4:6-8; Psalm 32:1-2**).

*For the promise to Abraham and to his offspring that he should be heir of the world wasn't through the law, but through the righteousness of faith. For if those who are of the law are heirs, faith is made void, and the promise is made of no effect. For the law produces wrath, for where there is no law, neither is there disobedience. For this cause it is of faith, that it may be according to grace, to the end that the promise may be sure to all the offspring, not to that only which is of the law, but to that also which is of the faith of Abraham, who is the father of us all.*

**ROMANS 4:13-16**

Paul's point in Romans 4:14 is not that the Torah is worthless. It is that if the inheritance came by our Torah keeping, the promise would stand on our performance, and faith would be empty. The promise stands on YHWH's faithfulness, **that the promise may be sure to all the offspring.**

## The Righteous Will Live by His Faith

*Behold, his soul is puffed up. It is not upright in him, but the righteous will live by his faith.*

**HABAKKUK 2:4**

Paul quotes Habakkuk in Romans 1:17 and Galatians 3:11. The Hebrew word for faith is *emunah* (H530), from *aman* (H539), the root of the word amen. It means firmness, steadiness, faithfulness. In Exodus 17:12, when Aaron and Hur held up the arms of Moses, Scripture says **his hands were steady until sunset**, and that word *steady* is *emunah*. Biblical faith is not a feeling that comes and goes. It is a trust that keeps standing and keeps holding on, all the way until sunset. The Greek *pistis* (G4102) carries that same weight.

## What Were the Works of the Law in Galatia?

Scripture tells us what the fight in Galatia and Antioch was about. Luke records it word for word:

*Some men came down from Judea and taught the brothers, "Unless you are circumcised after the custom of Moses, you can't be saved."*

**ACTS 15:1**

That was the false teaching: that a Gentile had to be circumcised and become a convert **in order to be saved**. False brothers were pressing Titus to be circumcised (**Galatians 2:3-5**), and Paul says plainly who he is writing to: **you who desire to be justified by the law (Galatians 5:4)**. Peter answered the same question at the Jerusalem council: **we believe that we are saved through the grace of Adonai Yahshua, just as they are (Acts 15:11)**. When Paul says a man is not justified by the works of the law, he is answering that teaching.

*yet knowing that a man is not justified by the works of the law but through faith in Yahshua Messiah, even we believed in Messiah Yahshua, that we might be justified by faith in Messiah, and not by the works of the law, because no flesh will be justified by the works of the law.*

**GALATIANS 2:16**

*I don't reject the grace of Elohim. For if righteousness is through the law, then Messiah died for nothing!*

**GALATIANS 2:21**

## The Curse Paul Is Talking About

*For as many as are of the works of the law are under a curse. For it is written, "Cursed is everyone who doesn't continue in all things that are written in the book of the law, to do them." Now that no man is justified by the law before Elohim is evident, for, "The righteous will live by faith." The law is not of faith, but, "The man who does them will live by them." Messiah redeemed us from the curse of the law, having become a curse for us. For it is written, "Cursed is everyone who hangs on a tree,"*

**GALATIANS 3:10-13**

Galatians 3:10 quotes Deuteronomy 27:26:

*Cursed is he who doesn't uphold the words of this law by doing them.' All the people shall say, 'Amen.*

**DEUTERONOMY 27:26**

Notice who the curse falls on. It is not on the one who keeps the instructions. It is on the one who does not uphold them. Since every one of us has fallen short, anyone who stands before Elohim on his own record of Torah keeping is standing under the curse he has already earned. Then Paul gives the good news: Messiah became a curse for us, quoting Deuteronomy 21:23 about the one who is hanged on a tree. He took the curse. He did not curse the Torah.

*Is the law then against the promises of Elohim? Certainly not! For if there had been a law given which could make alive, most certainly righteousness would have been of the law. But the Scripture imprisoned all things under sin, that the promise by faith in Yahshua Messiah might be given to those who believe.*

**GALATIANS 3:21-22**

Paul's own question in Galatians 3:21 settles the matter. The Torah is not against the promises of Elohim. It was never given to make a dead man alive. Life comes from the promise, received by faith.

## A Righteousness of My Own

*Yes most certainly, and I count all things to be a loss for the excellency of the knowledge of Messiah Yahshua, my Adonai, for whom I suffered the loss of all things, and count them nothing but refuse, that I may gain Messiah and be found in him, not having a righteousness of my own, that which is of the law, but that which is through faith in Messiah, the righteousness which is from Elohim by faith,*

**PHILIPPIANS 3:8-9**

Read the words carefully: **not having a righteousness of my own**. Paul counts his pedigree, his zeal, and his record as loss, not because obedience is evil, but because trusting his own record was. Isaiah said all our righteousness is like a polluted garment (**Isaiah 64:6**), and Jeremiah gave the Messiah his name: **YHWH our righteousness** (**Jeremiah 23:6**). The righteousness that saves comes **from Elohim by faith**.

## Not Under Law, but Under Grace

*For sin will not have dominion over you. For you are not under law, but under grace. What then? Shall we sin, because we are not under law, but under grace? May it never be!*

**ROMANS 6:14-15**

This is the verse many people lean on. Look at the words around it. **Sin will not have dominion over you**. The word for dominion is *kurieuo* (G2961), to rule as lord. Paul uses the same verb in Romans 6:9, where death no longer has dominion over the risen Messiah, and again in Romans 7:1, where he says the law **has dominion over a man for as long as he lives**. To be under law in Paul's sense is to stand under its rule as a condemned man, with its sentence of death over your head. Yahshua was born under law to redeem those who were under law (**Galatians 4:4-5**).

Then Paul immediately asks the question everyone asks: shall we sin because we are not under law? His answer is **May it never be!** And since sin is lawlessness (**1 John 3:4**), **not under law** cannot mean free to ignore the instructions. It means sin and its sentence no longer rule over you. Grace does not release you from obedience. It releases you from condemnation so you can finally obey (**Romans 8:1-2**).

## Discharged From the Law?

*Therefore, my brothers, you also were made dead to the law through the body of Messiah, that you would be joined to another, to him who was raised from the dead, that we might produce fruit to Elohim. For when we were in the flesh, the sinful passions which were through the law worked in our members to bring out fruit to death. But now we have been discharged from the law, having died to that in which we were held; so that we serve in newness of the spirit, and not in oldness of the letter.*

**ROMANS 7:4-6**

Paul's picture in Romans 7 is a death. We died with Messiah (**Romans 6:6**). The Torah's sentence over the old man was carried out at the stake, and now we are joined to the One who was raised from the dead, **that we might produce fruit to Elohim**. The contrast is not Torah versus no Torah. It is **newness of the spirit** versus **oldness of the letter**. The word for letter is *gramma* (G1121), what is written. Paul explains it in 2 Corinthians 3:3: the difference is where it is written, on tablets of stone or on tablets that are hearts of flesh. That is exactly what YHWH promised in Jeremiah 31:33 and Ezekiel 36:26-27. Same instructions. New address.

## Two Uses of the Same Verb

*You are alienated from Messiah, you who desire to be justified by the law. You have fallen away from grace.*

**GALATIANS 5:4**

### THE WORD STUDY THAT TIES IT TOGETHER

The word for **alienated** in Galatians 5:4 is *katargeo* (G2673), to render idle, useless, void. It is the exact verb Paul uses in Romans 3:31: **Do we then nullify the law through faith?**

So Paul says faith does not *katargeo* the Torah, but seeking to be justified by the Torah will *katargeo* you from Messiah. **The danger was never keeping the instructions. The danger is trusting them to save you.**

## SECTION III

## Truth Two: The Instructions Are Not Abolished

*Or is Elohim the Elohim of Jews only? Isn't he the Elohim of Gentiles also? Yes, of Gentiles also, since indeed there is one Elohim who will justify the circumcised by faith, and the uncircumcised through faith. Do we then nullify the law through faith? May it never be! No, we establish the law.*

**ROMANS 3:29-31**

Read the question right before verse 31: **Is Elohim the Elohim of Jews only?** Paul answers the teaching that the Torah is only for the Jews in the very passage where he says we establish it. There is one Elohim over Jew and Gentile, one way of being justified, and one Torah that faith establishes.

The word **establish** is *histemi* (G2476), to make stand, to set firmly in place. It is the opposite of *katargeo*. In Hebrew thought this is the verb *qum* (H6965), to rise, to stand, to confirm, the very word behind **uphold** in Deuteronomy 27:26. Faith does not knock the Torah down. Faith makes it stand.

Paul's strong answer, **May it never be**, is *me genoito*, the strongest no in his vocabulary. It carries the force of the Hebrew *chalilah* (H2486), far be it, the word Israel used in Joshua 24:16 when they said far be it from us to forsake YHWH. Paul uses it again the moment anyone suggests grace means permission to sin:

*What shall we say then? Shall we continue in sin, that grace may abound? May it never be! We who died to sin, how could we live in it any longer?*

**ROMANS 6:1-2**

## What Paul Actually Says About the Torah

*Therefore the law indeed is holy, and the commandment holy, and righteous, and good.*

**ROMANS 7:12**

Put that beside Nehemiah's prayer about Sinai and see how Paul is echoing it:

*You also came down on Mount Sinai, and spoke with them from heaven, and gave them right ordinances and true laws, good statutes and commandments.*

**NEHEMIAH 9:13**

Right, true, good. Holy, righteous, good. Paul is speaking the language of the prayers and psalms of Israel. The psalmist says **YHWH's law is perfect, restoring the soul (Psalm 19:7)** and **your law is truth (Psalm 119:142)**. Paul adds that **the law is spiritual, pneumatikos (G4152)**, while he himself is fleshly (**Romans 7:14**).

*For I delight in Elohim's law after the inward man,*

**ROMANS 7:22**

*but his delight is in YHWH's law. On his law he meditates day and night.*

**PSALM 1:2**

Paul's word for **delight** is *sunedomai* (G4913), to rejoice in, to take pleasure in. It is the heart of Psalm 1 and of Psalm 119: **your law is my delight (Psalm 119:77)** and **How I love your law! (Psalm 119:97)**. A man who thinks the Torah was nailed away does not talk like this. And at the end of the chapter Paul says, **with the mind, I myself serve Elohim's law (Romans 7:25)**.

## The Problem Was the Flesh, Not the Torah

*For what the law couldn't do, in that it was weak through the flesh, Elohim did, sending his own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh and for sin, he condemned sin in the flesh; that the ordinance of the law might be fulfilled in us, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.*

**ROMANS 8:3-4**

The Torah could not save because it was **weak through the flesh**. It could tell us the target, but it could not change the one holding the bow. So Elohim condemned sin in the flesh, **that the ordinance of the law might be fulfilled in us**. That word is *dikaionoma* (G1345), the righteous requirement, the just decree. The Spirit does not replace the instructions. The Spirit produces them in us.

*because the mind of the flesh is hostile toward Elohim; for it is not subject to Elohim's law, neither indeed can it be.*

**ROMANS 8:7**

Read that one slowly. It is the mind of the flesh that is not subject to Elohim's law. A Spirit filled mind is. This is the new covenant exactly as the prophets promised it:

*But this is the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel after those days," says YHWH: "I will put my law in their inward parts, and I will write it in their heart. I will be their Elohim, and they shall be my people.*

**JEREMIAH 31:33**

*I will also give you a new heart, and I will put a new spirit within you. I will take away the stony heart out of your flesh, and I will give you a heart of flesh. I will put my Spirit within you, and cause you to walk in my statutes. You will keep my ordinances and do them.*

**EZEKIEL 36:26-27**

*YHWH your Elohim will circumcise your heart, and the heart of your offspring, to love YHWH your Elohim with all your heart and with all your soul, that you may live.*

**DEUTERONOMY 30:6**

#### THE NEW COVENANT IN ONE LINE

YHWH did not promise new instructions. He promised a new heart, his own Spirit inside us, and **his** Torah written where stone could never reach. **The Spirit is how the instructions finally get kept.**

## Messiah Is the Goal of the Torah

*For Messiah is the fulfillment of the law for righteousness to everyone who believes.*

**ROMANS 10:4**

The word translated end or fulfillment is *telos* (G5056). Its basic meaning is the point aimed at, the goal. Paul uses it in 1 Timothy 1:5: **the goal of this command is love**. The Torah was always aiming at Messiah, the way an arrow aims at its target. You do not throw away the bow when the arrow hits the mark. Then watch what Paul does next. To describe the word of faith, he quotes Deuteronomy 30:12-14, the passage where Moses says the commandment is not too hard and not far away (**Romans 10:6-8**):

*But the word is very near to you, in your mouth and in your heart, that you may do it.*

**DEUTERONOMY 30:14**

Paul takes Moses' words about the commandment and uses them for the Good News. He does not see the Torah and faith as rivals. He sees the word that was near in Moses' day coming near in Messiah.

## Love Fulfills the Torah by Doing It

*Owe no one anything, except to love one another; for he who loves his neighbor has fulfilled the law. For the commandments, "You shall not commit adultery," "You shall not murder," "You shall not steal," "You shall not covet," and whatever other commandments there are, are all summed up in this saying, namely, "You shall love your neighbor as yourself." Love doesn't harm a neighbor. Love therefore is the fulfillment of the law.*

**ROMANS 13:8-10**

*You shall not take vengeance, nor bear any grudge against the children of your people; but you shall love your neighbor as yourself. I am YHWH.*

**LEVITICUS 19:18**

Paul's summary is a quote from Leviticus, and he lists the commandments themselves: do not commit adultery, do not murder, do not steal, do not covet. Love does not replace those. Love keeps them. Paul says the same in Galatians 5:13-14. The word for **fulfill** is *pleroo* (G4137), to fill to the full. It is the word Yahshua used:

*Don't think that I came to destroy the law or the prophets. I didn't come to destroy, but to fulfill. For most certainly, I tell you, until heaven and earth pass away, not even one smallest letter or one tiny pen stroke shall in any way pass away from the law, until all things are accomplished. Whoever, therefore, shall break one of these least commandments, and teach others to do so, shall be called least in the Kingdom of Heaven; but whoever shall do and teach them shall be called great in the Kingdom of Heaven.*

**MATTHEW 5:17-19**

If fulfill meant abolish, Yahshua would be saying, I did not come to abolish but to abolish. He came to fill the Torah full, to show its full meaning and to keep it perfectly, and he said the one who does and teaches the commandments will be called great in the Kingdom.

## What Matters to Paul

*Circumcision is nothing, and uncircumcision is nothing, but the keeping of the commandments of Elohim.*

**1 CORINTHIANS 7:19**

In 1 Corinthians 7:17-20 Paul is talking about the condition a person was in when YHWH called them. His point is that a man's status in the flesh, circumcised or not, does not make him right with Elohim. What shows he belongs to Elohim is **the keeping of the commandments of Elohim**. The word is *entole* (G1785), the same word used for the commandments throughout the Gospels, carrying the Hebrew *mitzvah* (H4687).

*To the Jews I became as a Jew, that I might gain Jews; to those who are under the law, as under the law, that I might gain those who are under the law; to those who are without law, as without law (not being without law toward Elohim, but under law toward Messiah), that I might win those who are without law.*

**1 CORINTHIANS 9:20-21**

Paul says he is **not without law toward Elohim**. Paul was never a lawless man. He also writes that **the law is good, if a person uses it lawfully** (1 Timothy 1:8), and that we fulfill **the law of Messiah** when we bear one another's burdens (Galatians 6:2).

## Is the Torah Only for the Jews?

*For the assembly, there shall be one statute for you and for the stranger who lives as a foreigner, a statute forever throughout your generations. As you are, so the foreigner shall be before YHWH. One law and one ordinance shall be for you and for the stranger who lives as a foreigner with you.*

**NUMBERS 15:15-16**

From the Exodus on, YHWH gave **one law** for the native born and for the stranger who joined Israel (**Exodus 12:49**). Isaiah promised that foreigners who join themselves to YHWH, love his name, keep the Sabbath, and hold fast his covenant would be brought to his holy mountain (**Isaiah 56:6-7**). Paul says Gentile believers are grafted into

Israel's olive tree and drink from the same root (**Romans 11:17-18**). Once they were **alienated from the commonwealth of Israel**, but now they are **fellow citizens** and members of the household of Elohim (**Ephesians 2:12, 19**). If you belong to Messiah, you are Abraham's offspring (**Galatians 3:29**).

*For he is not a Jew who is one outwardly, neither is that circumcision which is outward in the flesh; but he is a Jew who is one inwardly, and circumcision is that of the heart, in the spirit not in the letter; whose praise is not from men, but from Elohim.*

**ROMANS 2:28-29**

Circumcision of the heart was never a New Testament idea. Moses commanded it in Deuteronomy 10:16 and promised YHWH would do it in Deuteronomy 30:6. Paul is teaching Torah.

#### ONE TREE, ONE ROOT

Grafted in does not mean a second tree with a second set of rules. **One Elohim, one olive tree, one household, one set of instructions, and one way in: grace through faith.**

### How Paul Himself Lived

If Paul taught that the Torah was finished, the easiest way to prove it would have been his own life. Instead, when rumors spread that he taught Jews to forsake Moses, the elders in Jerusalem asked him to take part in a vow so that everyone would know the rumors were false:

*Take them and purify yourself with them, and pay their expenses for them, that they may shave their heads. Then all will know that there is no truth in the things that they have been informed about you, but that you yourself also walk keeping the law.*

**ACTS 21:24**

Paul did it (**Acts 21:26**). Later he told the governor, **Neither against the law of the Jews, nor against the temple, nor against Caesar, have I sinned at all** (**Acts 25:8**), and he told the Jewish leaders in Rome he had done nothing against the customs of the fathers (**Acts 28:17**). He hurried to be in Jerusalem for Pentecost (**Acts 20:16**). He told the mostly Gentile assembly in Corinth, **let's keep the feast** (**1 Corinthians 5:8**). And he said, **Be imitators of me, even as I also am of Messiah** (**1 Corinthians 11:1**).

#### SECTION IV

### Truth Three: Saved by Grace Through Faith

Grace is not a New Testament invention. The Greek word *charis* (G5485) is how the Greek Old Testament translated the Hebrew *chen* (H2580), favor. The first time the word appears is Genesis 6:8: **Noah found favor in YHWH's eyes**. Grace came before the ark was built. And when YHWH proclaimed his own name to Moses, grace was part of it:

*YHWH passed by before him, and proclaimed, "YHWH! YHWH, a merciful and gracious Elohim, slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness and truth,*

**EXODUS 34:6**

**Merciful and gracious** is *rachum* (H7349) and *channun* (H2587). Grace is not YHWH changing his mind about the Torah. Grace is his name.

## Egypt First, Then Sinai

Look at the order YHWH used with Israel. He did not give them the Ten Commandments in Egypt and tell them to keep them so they could be set free. The blood went on the doorposts, the sea opened, and Pharaoh's army went under. Then he brought them to the mountain:

*You have seen what I did to the Egyptians, and how I bore you on eagles' wings, and brought you to myself.*

**EXODUS 19:4**

*I am YHWH your Elohim, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage.*

**EXODUS 20:2**

The Ten Commandments begin with redemption. And when an Israelite son asked what the instructions meant, the answer began, **We were Pharaoh's slaves in Egypt, and YHWH brought us out (Deuteronomy 6:20-23)**. Obedience was never the price of redemption. It is the walk of a redeemed people.

### THE PATTERN

**Grace, then instruction. Redemption, then walking.** The blood on the door came before the words on the stone. Paul did not change YHWH's order. He preached it.

## The Grace That Saves

*Being therefore justified by faith, we have peace with Elohim through our Adonai Yahshua Messiah; through whom we also have our access by faith into this grace in which we stand. We rejoice in hope of the glory of Elohim.*

**ROMANS 5:1-2**

Peace with Elohim is the Hebrew *shalom*, and Isaiah told us where it comes from: **The punishment that brought our peace was on him; and by his wounds we are healed (Isaiah 53:5)**.

*But Elohim commends his own love toward us, in that while we were yet sinners, Messiah died for us.*

**ROMANS 5:8**

*The law came in that the trespass might abound; but where sin abounded, grace abounded more exceedingly; that as sin reigned in death, even so grace might reign through righteousness to eternal life through Yahshua Messiah our Adonai.*

**ROMANS 5:20-21**

*And if by grace, then it is no longer of works; otherwise grace is no longer grace. But if it is of works, it is no longer grace; otherwise work is no longer work.*

**ROMANS 11:6**

*for by grace you have been saved through faith, and that not of yourselves; it is the gift of Elohim, not of works, that no one would boast. For we are his workmanship, created in Messiah Yahshua for good works, which Elohim prepared before that we would walk in them.*

**EPHESIANS 2:8-10**

Verse 10 is the part that often gets left off. We are his **workmanship**, *poiema* (G4161), the thing he made, his handiwork. We are created **for good works, which Elohim prepared before that we would walk in them**. The word walk is *peripateo* (G4043), which carries the Hebrew *halak* (H1980), the word Moses used for walking in YHWH's ways (**Deuteronomy 30:16**) and Micah used for walking humbly with your Elohim (**Micah 6:8**). Where did Elohim write down the good works he prepared beforehand? In his instructions.

## Grace Is a Teacher

*For the grace of Elohim has appeared, bringing salvation to all men, instructing us to the intent that, denying ungodliness and worldly lusts, we would live soberly, righteously, and godly in this present age; looking for the blessed hope and appearing of the glory of our great Elohim and Savior, Yahshua Messiah, who gave himself for us, that he might redeem us from all iniquity, and purify for himself a people for his own possession, zealous for good works.*

**TITUS 2:11-14**

Grace **instructs** us, *paideuo* (G3811), trains us like a child, to deny ungodliness. Then Paul reaches back into the Tanakh twice. **Redeem us from all iniquity** echoes Psalm 130:8, where YHWH will redeem Israel from all their iniquities, and the word Paul uses for iniquity is *anomia*, lawlessness. **A people for his own possession** is *periousios* (G4041), the same word the Greek Old Testament used in Exodus 19:5 for Israel as YHWH's *segullah* (H5459), his treasured possession, right before Sinai. Grace redeems us from lawlessness and makes us his treasured people, **zealous for good works**.

*not by works of righteousness which we did ourselves, but according to his mercy, he saved us through the washing of regeneration and renewing by the Holy Spirit, whom he poured out on us richly, through Yahshua Messiah our Savior; that being justified by his grace, we might be made heirs according to the hope of eternal life. This saying is faithful, and concerning these things I desire that you affirm confidently, so that those who have believed Elohim may be careful to maintain good works. These things are good and profitable to men;*

**TITUS 3:5-8**

**The washing of regeneration and renewing by the Holy Spirit** is Ezekiel 36:25-27: **I will sprinkle clean water on you, I will put my Spirit within you, and cause you to walk in my statutes**. And Paul closes the thought by telling Titus to insist on this, so that believers **may be careful to maintain good works**.

## SECTION V

## Truth Four: The Faith That Saves Goes to Work

*who "will pay back to everyone according to their works:" to those who by perseverance in well-doing seek for glory, honor, and incorruptibility, eternal life;*

**ROMANS 2:6-7**

Paul is quoting Psalm 62:12: **you reward every man according to his work** (see also **Proverbs 24:12**). Works do not buy salvation, but they reveal what is in the heart, and Elohim judges what they reveal. Paul adds that it is **the doers of the law** who will be justified, and that Gentiles can show **the work of the law written in their hearts** (**Romans 2:13-15**). That is Jeremiah 31:33 again.

*Don't you know that when you present yourselves as servants and obey someone, you are the servants of whomever you obey; whether of sin to death, or of obedience to righteousness?*

**ROMANS 6:16**

This is Moses at the edge of the Jordan: **I have set before you today life and prosperity, and death and evil**, followed by the call to love YHWH, walk in his ways, and keep his commandments (**Deuteronomy 30:15-16**). Who you obey shows who you belong to.

*Therefore I urge you, brothers, by the mercies of Elohim, to present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable to Elohim, which is your spiritual service. Don't be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind, so that you may prove what is the good, well-pleasing, and perfect will of Elohim.*

**ROMANS 12:1-2**

A living sacrifice is Temple language. Our worship is to lay our whole bodies on the altar. Then Paul fills the rest of Romans 12 with what that looks like, and it is Torah from beginning to end. **Don't seek revenge** (**Romans 12:19**) is Leviticus 19:18. **Vengeance belongs to me; I will repay** is Deuteronomy 32:35. **If your enemy is hungry, feed him** (**Romans 12:20**) is Proverbs 25:21-22. Paul's picture of a transformed life is the instructions of YHWH walked out in love.

## Faith Working Through Love

*For in Messiah Yahshua neither circumcision amounts to anything, nor uncircumcision, but faith working through love.*

**GALATIANS 5:6**

*But I say, walk by the Spirit, and you won't fulfill the lust of the flesh. For the flesh lusts against the Spirit, and the Spirit against the flesh; and these are contrary to one another, that you may not do the things that you desire. But if you are led by the Spirit, you are not under the law.*

**GALATIANS 5:16-18**

Walk by the Spirit and you will not carry out the lust of the flesh. Being **led by the Spirit** means you are not under the Torah's condemnation, because the Spirit is leading you into what the Torah describes. Paul lists the deeds of the flesh, adultery, sexual immorality, idolatry, sorcery, hatred, drunkenness, and warns that **those who practice such things will not inherit Elohim's Kingdom** (**Galatians 5:19-21**). Every one of those is named as sin in the Torah. Then he gives the fruit:

*But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faith, gentleness, and self-control. Against such things there is no law.*

**GALATIANS 5:22-23**

**Against such things there is no law.** No commandment of YHWH has ever stood against love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self control. The fruit of the Spirit and the instructions of YHWH

point at the same target.

## Work Out What He Works In

*So then, my beloved, even as you have always obeyed, not only in my presence, but now much more in my absence, work out your own salvation with fear and trembling. For it is Elohim who works in you both to will and to work, for his good pleasure.*

**PHILIPPIANS 2:12-13**

**Fear and trembling** is the language of Psalm 2:11: **Serve YHWH with fear, and rejoice with trembling.** We do not work **for** our salvation. We work **out** what Elohim has worked in, and even the desire to obey is his gift.

*For this cause, we also, since the day we heard this, don't cease praying and making requests for you, that you may be filled with the knowledge of his will in all spiritual wisdom and understanding, that you may walk worthily of Adonai, to please him in all respects, bearing fruit in every good work and increasing in the knowledge of Elohim,*

**COLOSSIANS 1:9-10**

*remembering without ceasing your work of faith and labor of love and perseverance of hope in our Adonai Yahshua Messiah, before our Elohim and Father.*

**1 THESSALONIANS 1:3**

Faith produces work. Love produces labor. Hope produces perseverance. Paul never pictures a faith that sits still.

## His Seal on Those Who Are His

*However Elohim's firm foundation stands, having this seal, "Adonai knows those who are his," and, "Let every one who names the name of Adonai depart from unrighteousness."*

**2 TIMOTHY 2:19**

Both halves of that seal come from the Torah and the Prophets. **Adonai knows those who are his** is Numbers 16:5, where the Hebrew reads YHWH, spoken during Korah's rebellion. **Depart from unrighteousness** echoes Moses telling the congregation to **depart from the tents of these wicked men** (Numbers 16:26) and Isaiah's call, **Depart! Depart! Go out from there! Touch no unclean thing!** (Isaiah 52:11). Belonging to YHWH and departing from iniquity are one seal with two sides.

## Paul and James Are Not at War

Both Paul and James quote Genesis 15:6. Paul points to the moment Abraham believed in Genesis 15, before he had done anything, and says righteousness was credited to him (**Romans 4:2-3**). James points to Genesis 22, years later, when Abraham offered Isaac, and says **faith worked with his works, and by works faith was perfected**, so that the Scripture was fulfilled (**James 2:21-23**). Paul shows how Abraham was declared righteous. James shows how that faith proved real. Paul says the same thing himself in Galatians 5:6: **faith working through love.**

*Even so faith, if it has no works, is dead in itself. Yes, a man will say, "You have faith, and I have works." Show me your faith without works, and I will show you my faith by my works.*

**JAMES 2:17-18**

## SECTION VI

## Honest Answers to the Hard Verses

Paul is hard to understand in places, just as Peter said. Here are the verses most often used to say the instructions were done away, read in their own context.

*For he is our peace, who made both one, and broke down the middle wall of separation, having abolished in his flesh the hostility, the law of commandments contained in ordinances, that he might create in himself one new man of the two, making peace,*

**EPHESIANS 2:14-15**

- **Ephesians 2:14-15.** Look at what is abolished: **the hostility**, the middle wall that separated Jew from Gentile. The word for ordinances is *dogma* (G1378), a decree, the same word Luke uses for Caesar's decree in Luke 2:1. The result Paul describes is Gentiles brought near to the commonwealth of Israel as fellow citizens (**Ephesians 2:12, 19**), not Israel's instructions deleted. Paul would not call the commandment **holy, righteous, and good** in Romans 7:12 and then call it the hostility that Messiah abolished.
- **Colossians 2:14.** What was nailed to the stake was **the handwriting in ordinances which was against us**. The word is *cheirographon* (G5498), a handwritten record, a certificate of debt. Verse 13 tells us what was on it: **our trespasses**, which he forgave. The record of our debt was nailed up, not the instructions that defined it. In verses 20-22 Paul goes on to warn against ordinances like **Don't handle, nor taste, nor touch**, which he calls **the precepts and doctrines of men**.
- **Colossians 2:16-17.** Paul tells them not to let anyone judge them regarding food, feasts, new moons, or Sabbaths, which are **a shadow of the things to come**. A shadow of something still coming has not passed away. The ones judging were pushing man made rules and harsh treatment of the body (**Colossians 2:20-23**).
- **Galatians 3:24-25.** The tutor is *paidagogos* (G3807), the household guardian who walked a child to his teacher. The Torah held us in custody under the sentence of sin and led us to Messiah to be justified by faith. That custody ends. What the guardian taught about right and wrong does not become wrong when the child grows up.
- **Galatians 5:2-3.** Paul is speaking to men receiving circumcision as their way into righteousness, the same men he calls **you who desire to be justified by the law** in verse 4. His warning is against circumcision as a ticket to salvation, which makes a man a debtor to be perfect.
- **2 Corinthians 3:6-11.** What was fading was the glory on Moses' face, and the ministry that could only condemn. Paul's contrast in verse 3 is where the instructions are written: on stone or on hearts. Jeremiah 31:33 promised the same Torah on the heart.
- **Romans 14:1-5.** The chapter is about **disputes over opinions**, one man eating only vegetables and one man esteeming certain days. It never names the Sabbath or the commandments of Elohim, and Paul would not call a commandment of YHWH a matter of opinion.
- **Acts 15.** The council ruled that Gentiles do not have to be circumcised to be saved (**Acts 15:1, 11**). James gave them four things to start with and then the reason: **For Moses from generations of old has in every city those who preach him, being read in the synagogues every Sabbath (Acts 15:21)**. The new believers would keep learning Moses.

**THE TEST WE APPLY**

Where Scripture speaks, we follow it. Where Scripture is silent, we do not make up a commandment, and we do not make up a cancellation either. **Paul never says the instructions of YHWH are abolished. He says they cannot save, and that faith establishes them.**

**SECTION VII****Putting It All Together**

Paul teaches one unified message, and every piece of it is rooted in Moses and the Prophets:

- **The Torah cannot justify.** No flesh is declared righteous by its own record. **Romans 3:20; Psalm 143:2**
- **Grace saves through faith.** Righteousness is credited to the one who trusts YHWH, just as it was to Abraham. **Ephesians 2:8-9; Genesis 15:6**
- **Grace came first and always has.** Redemption from Egypt came before Sinai. **Exodus 20:2; Deuteronomy 6:20-25**
- **Faith establishes the Torah.** It does not nullify it. **Romans 3:31**
- **The Spirit writes it on the heart.** The new covenant is YHWH's Torah in a new heart. **Jeremiah 31:33; Ezekiel 36:26-27; Romans 8:4**
- **Love fulfills the Torah by keeping it.** **Romans 13:8-10; Leviticus 19:18**
- **Works prove faith is alive.** We are saved for good works, not by them. **Ephesians 2:10; Galatians 5:6; James 2:17-18**
- **One Torah for everyone who comes in.** Grafted in, fellow citizens, Abraham's seed. **Numbers 15:15-16; Romans 11:17-18; Ephesians 2:19**

**SAY IT PLAINLY**

**We do not obey to be saved. We obey because we are saved.** The same Elohim who saved us by grace wrote down how his people walk, and then he put his Spirit in us so we could walk it.

**Walking It Out This Week**

1. **Settle where your righteousness comes from.** Thank YHWH out loud that you are justified by his grace through faith in Yahshua, not by your record. Let that silence the accuser.
2. **Read the verse Paul was standing on.** Every time Paul quotes the Tanakh this week, turn back and read the original passage in its setting.
3. **Ask what Paul means by law.** Before drawing a conclusion from any verse, ask which law he is talking about and what he is saying it can or cannot do.
4. **Pick one instruction and walk in it.** Not to earn anything, but because you love him and he asked. Let the Spirit write it on your heart.

5. **Check your fruit.** Read Galatians 5:22-23 and ask the Spirit to show you one area where love is not yet working itself out.
6. **Humble yourself toward others.** Grace received should become grace given. Forgive the person who comes to mind, the way you have been forgiven.
7. **Share it gently.** Many believers were simply taught otherwise. Answer with Scripture, patience, and kindness.

## SECTION VIII

## Word Study Key

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- **Torah, H8451.** Instruction, teaching; from yarah, H3384, to shoot or point out the target. Greek nomos, G3551
- **Chata, H2398.** To miss the mark; to sin. Judges 20:16
- **Anomia, G458.** Lawlessness. 1 John 3:4; Titus 2:14
- **Athesmos, G113.** Lawless, setting aside what is established. 2 Peter 3:17
- **Dikaioo, G1344 / Tsadaq, H6663.** To declare righteous, a courtroom ruling. Deuteronomy 25:1; Isaiah 53:11; Romans 3:28
- **Logizomai, G3049 / Chashab, H2803.** To count, credit, reckon to an account. Genesis 15:6; Romans 4:3
- **Pistis, G4102 / Emunah, H530.** Faith, steadiness, faithfulness; root aman, H539. Exodus 17:12; Habakkuk 2:4
- **Charis, G5485 / Chen, H2580.** Grace, favor. Genesis 6:8; Ephesians 2:8
- **Channun, H2587 / Rachum, H7349.** Gracious, compassionate, part of YHWH's own name. Exodus 34:6
- **Hilasterion, G2435 / Kapporet, H3727.** Mercy seat, place of atonement. Exodus 25:22; Romans 3:25; Hebrews 9:5
- **Apolutrosis, G629 / Go'el, H1350.** Redemption, full ransom; kinsman redeemer. Leviticus 25:25; Romans 3:24
- **Dorean, G1432.** Freely, as a gift. Romans 3:24
- **Katargeo, G2673.** To render idle, void, useless. Romans 3:31; Galatians 5:4
- **Histemi, G2476 / Qum, H6965.** To make stand, establish, uphold. Romans 3:31; Deuteronomy 27:26
- **Chalilah, H2486.** Far be it; the force behind Paul's May it never be. Joshua 24:16
- **Kurieuo, G2961.** To rule as lord, to have dominion. Romans 6:9, 14; 7:1
- **Gramma, G1121.** Letter, what is written. Romans 7:6; 2 Corinthians 3:6
- **Pneumatikos, G4152.** Spiritual. Romans 7:14
- **Sunedomai, G4913.** To delight in. Romans 7:22
- **Dikaioia, G1345.** Righteous requirement, just decree. Romans 8:4
- **Telos, G5056.** Goal, the point aimed at. Romans 10:4; 1 Timothy 1:5
- **Pleroo, G4137.** To fill to the full. Matthew 5:17; Romans 13:8; Galatians 5:14
- **Entole, G1785 / Mitzvah, H4687.** Commandment. 1 Corinthians 7:19
- **Poiema, G4161.** Workmanship, handiwork. Ephesians 2:10
- **Peripateo, G4043 / Halak, H1980.** To walk, to live out. Ephesians 2:10; Deuteronomy 30:16; Micah 6:8
- **Paideuo, G3811.** To train, instruct as a child. Titus 2:12
- **Periousios, G4041 / Segullah, H5459.** Treasured possession. Exodus 19:5; Titus 2:14
- **Dogma, G1378.** Decree. Luke 2:1; Ephesians 2:15
- **Cheirographon, G5498.** Handwritten record, certificate of debt. Colossians 2:14

- **Paidagogos, G3807.** Guardian who led a child to his teacher. Galatians 3:24

## SECTION IX

## Cross Reference Index

**Primary texts:** Romans 3:20-31; Galatians 2:16; Ephesians 2:8-10; Romans 7:12; Romans 8:3-4

**Reading Paul rightly:** 2 Peter 3:15-17; 2 Timothy 3:15-17; Acts 17:11; Acts 24:14; 1 John 3:4; Judges 20:16

**Not justified by the instructions:** Romans 3:20, 28; Psalm 143:2; Romans 4:1-16; Genesis 15:6; Psalm 32:1-2; Romans 6:14; Romans 7:4-6; Galatians 2:16, 21; Galatians 3:10-13, 21; Deuteronomy 27:26; Deuteronomy 21:23; Habakkuk 2:4; Galatians 5:4; Philippians 3:4-9; Isaiah 64:6; Jeremiah 23:6; Acts 15:1, 11

**Atonement and redemption:** Romans 3:24-26; Exodus 25:22; Leviticus 16:14-15; Hebrews 9:5; Leviticus 25:25; Isaiah 44:6; Isaiah 53:5, 11

**The instructions are not abolished:** Romans 3:31; Romans 6:1-2, 15; Romans 7:7, 12, 14, 22, 25; Nehemiah 9:13; Psalm 1:2; Psalm 19:7; Psalm 119:77, 97, 142; Romans 8:3-4, 7; Romans 10:4-8; Deuteronomy 30:11-14; Romans 13:8-10; Leviticus 19:18; Galatians 5:13-14; Matthew 5:17-19; 1 Corinthians 7:19; 1 Corinthians 9:20-21; 1 Timothy 1:8; Galatians 6:2

**The new covenant:** Jeremiah 31:33; Ezekiel 36:25-27; Deuteronomy 30:6; Deuteronomy 10:16; 2 Corinthians 3:3, 6; Romans 2:13-15, 28-29

**One Torah for all who come in:** Exodus 12:49; Numbers 15:15-16; Isaiah 56:6-7; Romans 11:17-18; Ephesians 2:12-19; Galatians 3:29

**How Paul lived:** Acts 20:16; Acts 21:20-26; Acts 24:14; Acts 25:8; Acts 28:17; 1 Corinthians 5:8; 1 Corinthians 11:1

**Saved by grace:** Genesis 6:8; Exodus 34:6; Exodus 19:4-5; Exodus 20:2; Deuteronomy 6:20-25; Romans 3:24; Romans 5:1-2, 8, 20-21; Romans 11:6; Ephesians 2:8-10; Titus 2:11-14; Psalm 130:8; Titus 3:5-8

**Works show faith:** Romans 2:6-7; Psalm 62:12; Proverbs 24:12; Romans 6:16-23; Deuteronomy 30:15-16; Romans 12:1-21; Deuteronomy 32:35; Proverbs 25:21-22; Galatians 5:6, 16-23; Philippians 2:12-13; Psalm 2:11; Colossians 1:9-10; 1 Thessalonians 1:3; 2 Timothy 2:19; Numbers 16:5, 26; Isaiah 52:11; James 2:17-23; Micah 6:8

**Hard verses:** Ephesians 2:14-15; Colossians 2:13-23; Galatians 3:24-25; Galatians 5:2-4; 2 Corinthians 3:6-11; Romans 14:1-5; Acts 15:1-21; Luke 2:1

**NOTES****Personal Notes and Convictions**

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Kingdom Life Ministry  
Restoring YHWH's design for marriage, family, forgiveness, and deliverance.

***Walk in truth, walk in light. Shalom.***